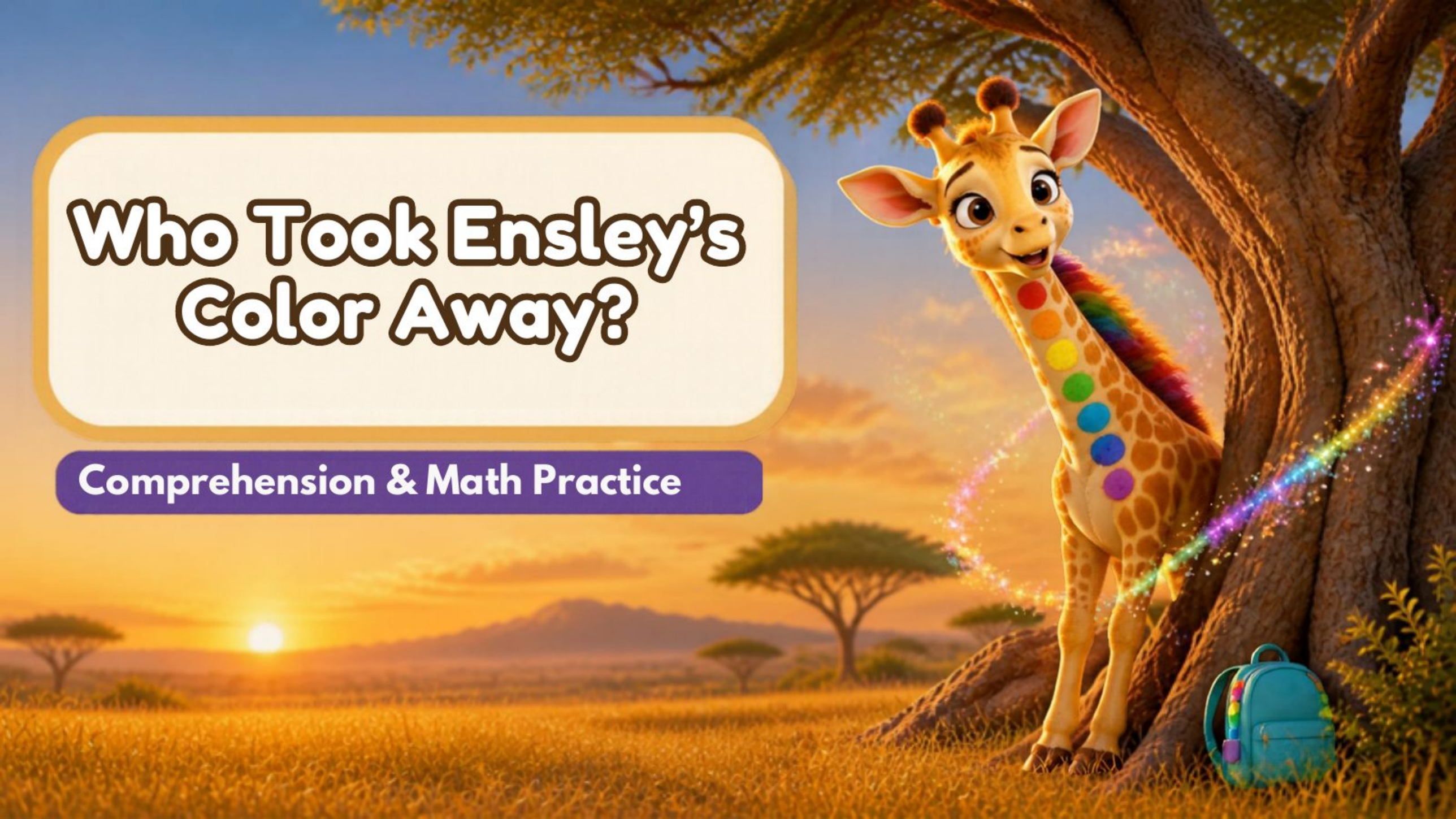
Who Took Ensley's Color Away?

Comprehension & Math Practice



Story Questions

1. Where did Ensley want to go when school was over?

2. Why was Ensley upset at the beginning of the story?

3. Where was Ensley's pencil when she thought it was lost?

4. How did Ensley feel when she got an answer wrong?



What Happened Next?

5. What happened to Ensley's red spot?

6. What happened after Ensley read a hard word correctly?

7. What distracted Ensley during the memory game?

8. What did Ensley make to help solve the mystery?



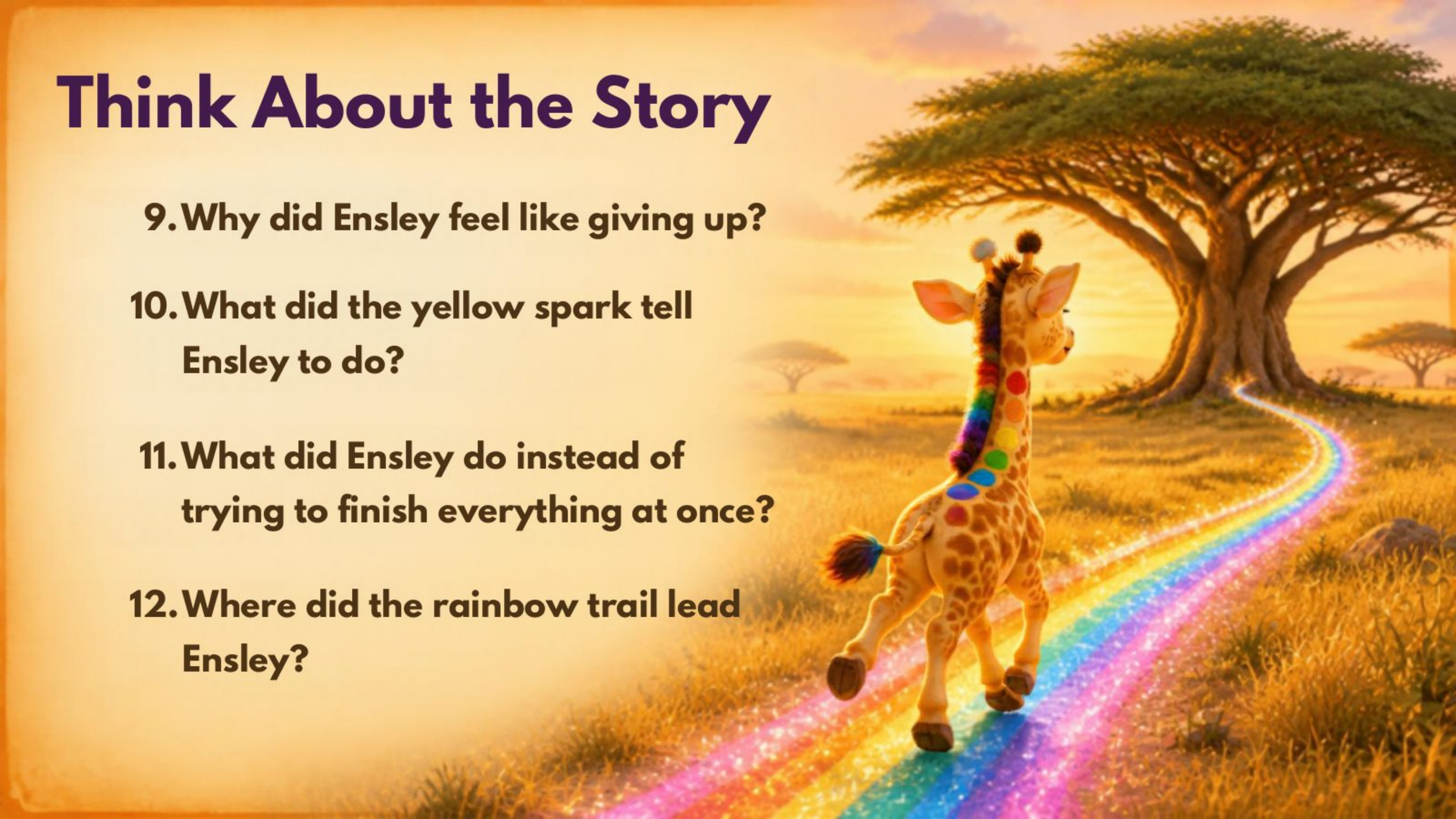
Think About the Story

9. Why did Ensley feel like giving up?

10. What did the yellow spark tell Ensley to do?

11. What did Ensley do instead of trying to finish everything at once?

12. Where did the rainbow trail lead Ensley?



The Mystery Solved

13. What did Ensley find under the glowing colors?

14. Were the colors really stolen?

15. What made the colors grow brighter?

16. What did Ensley learn about getting an answer wrong?



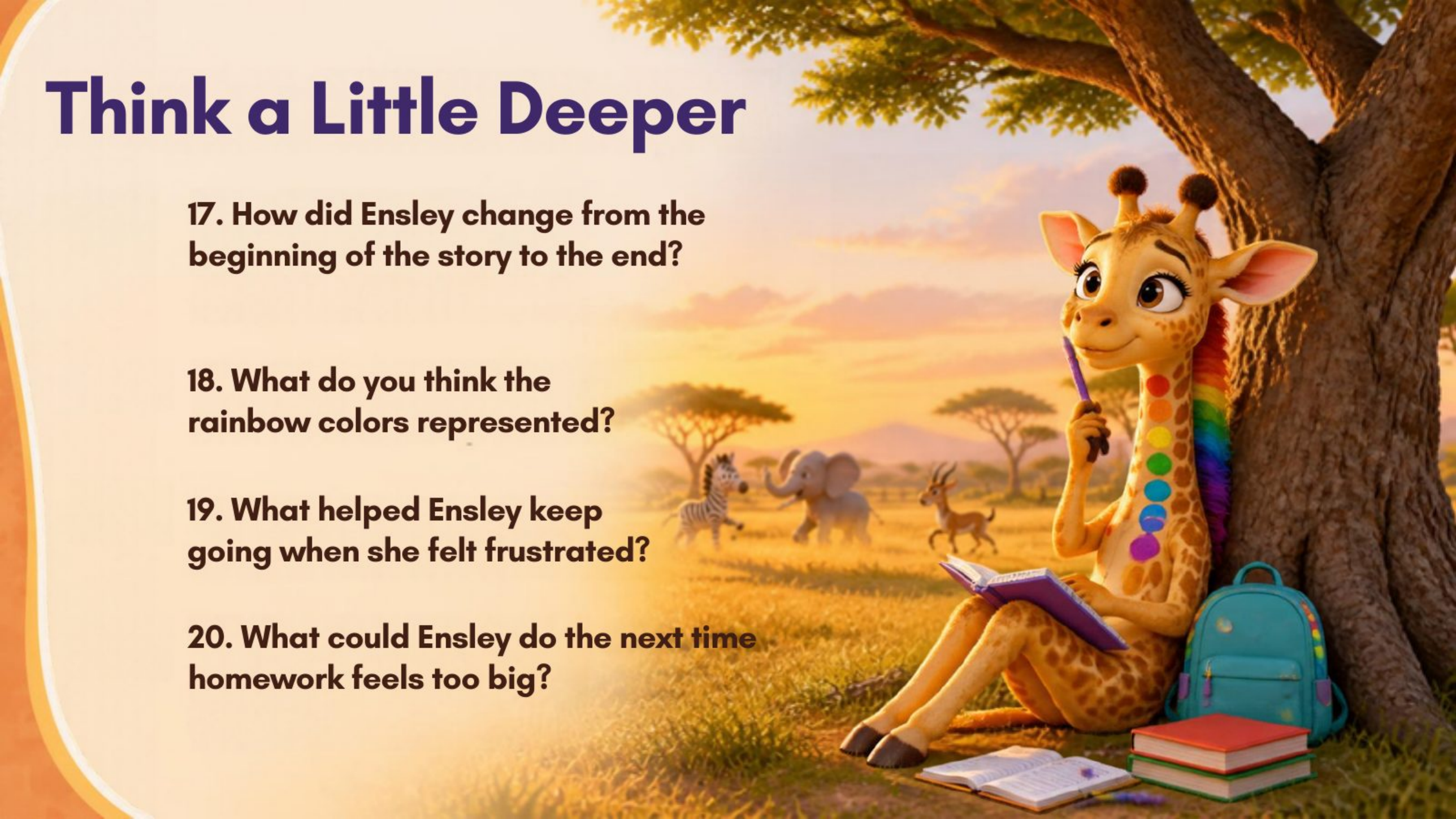
Think a Little Deeper

17. How did Ensley change from the beginning of the story to the end?

18. What do you think the rainbow colors represented?

19. What helped Ensley keep going when she felt frustrated?

20. What could Ensley do the next time homework feels too big?



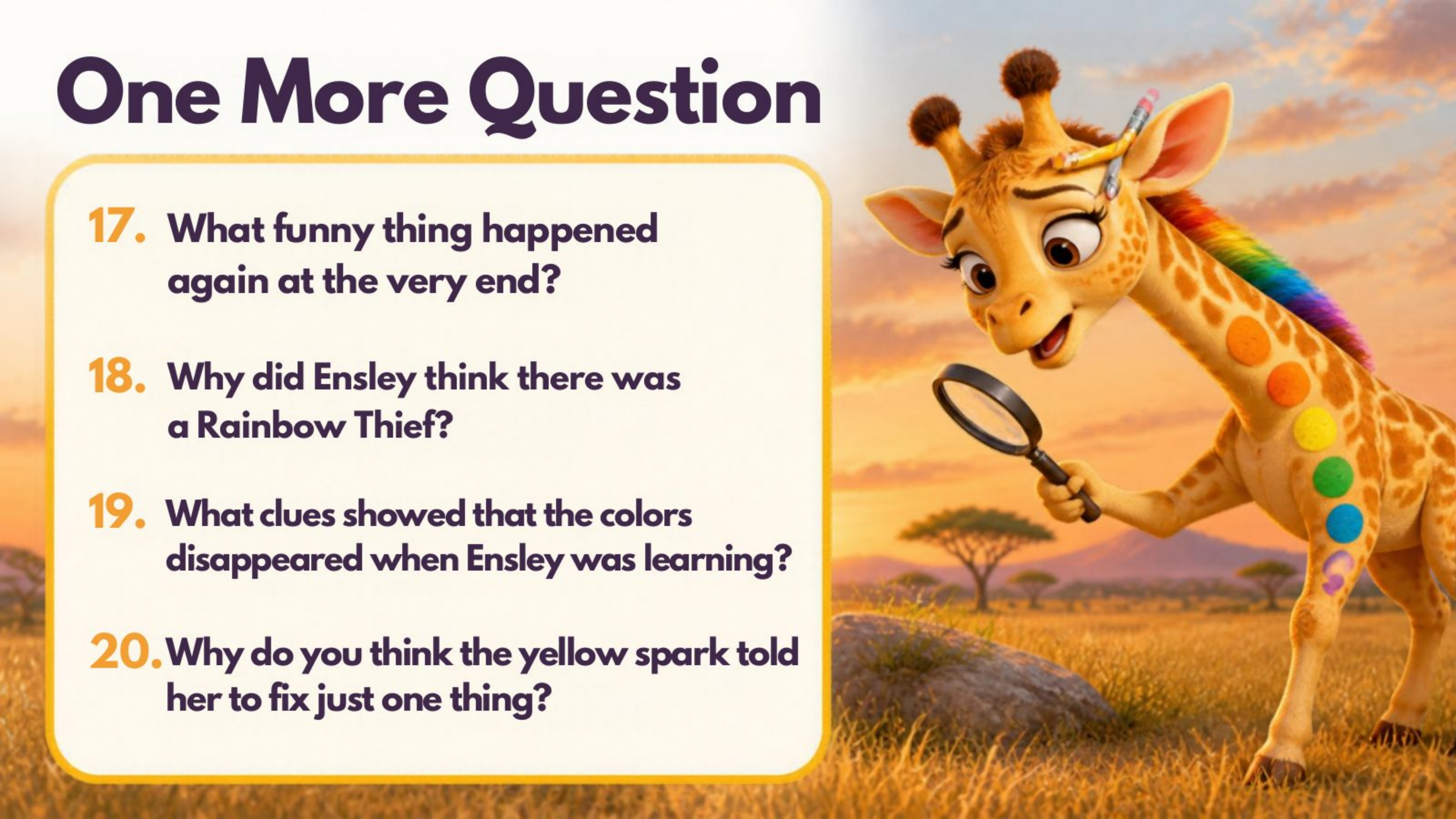
One More Question

17. What funny thing happened again at the very end?

18. Why did Ensley think there was a Rainbow Thief?

19. What clues showed that the colors disappeared when Ensley was learning?

20. Why do you think the yellow spark told her to fix just one thing?



Comprehension Answer Guide

13

She wanted to play outside.

She had a lot of homework and wanted to play.

Behind her ear.

Frustrated, upset, or worried.

It disappeared and became a red spark.

A blue spark appeared and her blue spot disappeared.

A butterfly.

A clue board.

She had gotten several answers wrong and felt overwhelmed.

To look again, fix one thing, and follow the light.

She chose just one problem.

To the old acacia tree.

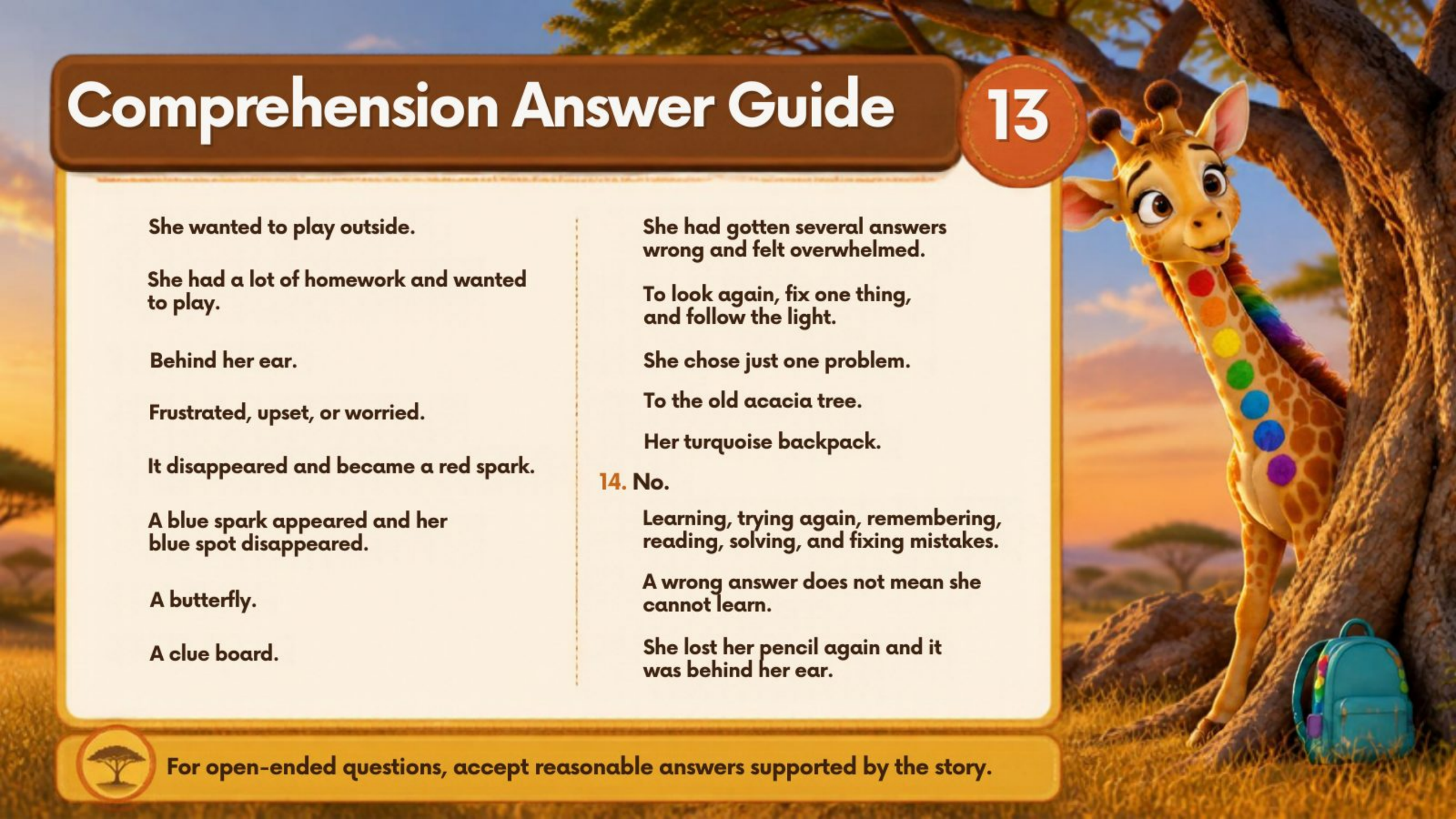
Her turquoise backpack.

14. No.

Learning, trying again, remembering, reading, solving, and fixing mistakes.

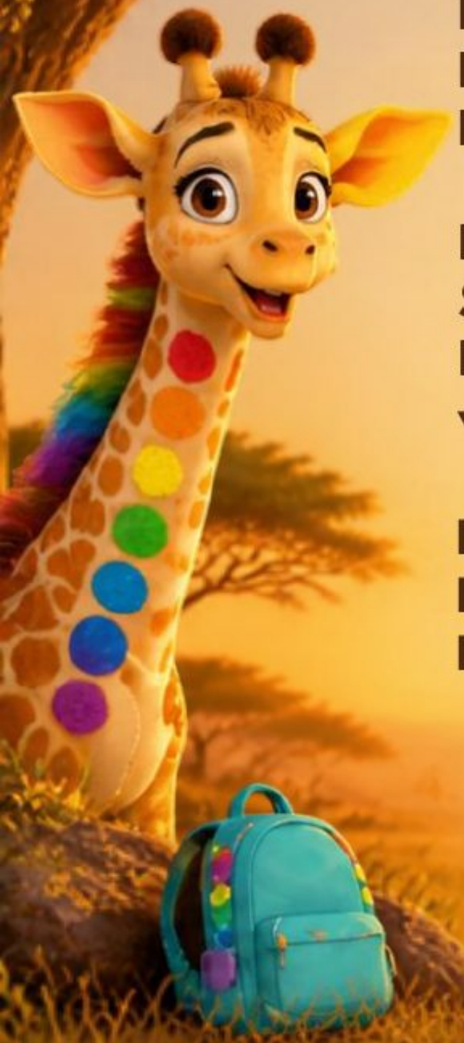
A wrong answer does not mean she cannot learn.

She lost her pencil again and it was behind her ear.



For open-ended questions, accept reasonable answers supported by the story.

Mango Math



Ensley had 4 mango slices.
Her mom gave her 2 more.
How many mango slices did Ensley have altogether?



Ensley had 6 mango slices.
She ate 2.
How many mango slices were left?



Ensley had 3 mango slices.
Her mom gave her 4 more.
How many did she have altogether?



Ensley had 7 mango slices.
She ate 3.
How many were left?



Bird Math

1. There were 7 birds in an acacia tree. 3 birds flew away. How many birds were still in the tree?



2. There were 5 birds on one branch. 2 more birds landed. How many birds were there now?



3. There were 8 birds in a tree. 4 flew away. How many were left?



4. There were 3 birds on a branch. 5 more came. How many birds were there altogether?



Zebra Math

1. 2 zebras stood by the old tree.
3 more zebras walked over.
How many zebras were there altogether?



2. There were 6 zebras near the tree.
2 zebras walked away.
How many zebras were left?



3. 4 zebras were drinking water.
3 more came over.
How many zebras were there now?



4. There were 7 zebras in the grass.
3 ran away.
How many stayed?



Grassland Math

1. Ensley saw 3 butterflies near the flowers. Then 4 more butterflies came. How many butterflies did she see altogether?



2. Ensley had 8 pencils on the table. 3 rolled onto the floor. How many pencils stayed on the table?



3. Ensley had 5 books beside her homework. Her mom brought her 2 more books. How many books did she have now?



4. Ensley saw 9 rainbow sparks. 4 disappeared behind the tree. How many sparks could she still see?



Try These Without Pictures

1. Ensley had 5 mango slices and got 3 more.
   How many did she have?

2. There were 8 birds and 2 flew away.
   How many were left?

3. 4 zebras stood by a tree and 2 more came.
   How many zebras were there?

4. Ensley had 7 pencils and lost 3.
   How many pencils did she still have?



Math Answer Key

Mango Math:	1. 6	2. 4	3. 7	4. 4
Bird Math:	1. 4	2. 7	3. 4	4. 8
Zebra Math:	1. 5	2. 4	3. 7	4. 4
Grassland Math:	1. 7	2. 5	3. 7	4. 5
Mixed Challenge:	1. 8	2. 6	3. 6	4. 4